For brands whose first product is selling

When should you reorder to avoid a stockout?

Work backward from
your sell-out date

Comparison (example)	Weeks
Weeks your stock will last	8
Total replenishment time (incl. buffer)	12

The math, plus questions for your manufacturer →

This year

Manufacturers' lines are reported to be full

Kolmar Korea ran at 84% capacity utilization in Q2, and major ODMs were reported to be booked through year-end. (MTN, Sept 15)

One indie brand representative said **“even orders placed in April and May have not shipped yet.”** (MyDaily, Aug 25)

Before counting your weeks of stock left, count how many weeks it takes to make more.

Try it · example numbers

Plug in your own numbers

1,200 units ÷ 150 sold per week = sold out in 8 weeks

Containers & cartons arrive	**4 weeks**
Production queue	**3 weeks**
Production & QC	**2 weeks**
Receiving & shipping prep	**1 week**
Buffer (safety stock)	**2 weeks**
Total replenishment time (incl. 2-week buffer)	**12 weeks**

12 weeks − 8 weeks = 4 weeks past the planned reorder point.

Example · assumes steady sales, no extra incoming stock, steps in sequence

If your weeks of stock are shorter, the stockout risk is already there

Already late? Three things to check with your manufacturer

1. **Split delivery**
   Take part of the order first instead of waiting for the full quantity

2. **Order the slowest material first**
   Start with whichever of containers or cartons has the longer lead time

3. **Production schedule changes**
   Get a date, not 'we'll get back to you'

> Manufacturers are reportedly splitting deliveries and adjusting schedules. (MyDaily, Aug 25, 2026)

Questions for your manufacturer

Ask these three first

1. **Where does the lead time start?**
   From the order date or from when all materials arrive? The same '6 weeks' can mean a different calendar date

2. **Which material arrives last?**
   What it is and how many weeks it takes

3. **Can you split the delivery?**
   If so, what is the minimum quantity?

> Once a week, compare **weeks of stock left** with the **total replenishment time, including your safety buffer**. To keep that buffer, reorder no later than when the two are equal. If your weeks of stock are shorter, you have passed the planned reorder point.